

The Storm at Heron's Rest: answers

Year 5 · 14 marks. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. Four generations. (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). A fact to find in the second paragraph.

2. His mother was away at the mainland hospital. (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). The reason is stated, so the child practises locating and rewording it.

3. winding (1 mark)

Word meaning (2a). Practises matching a word to a description.

4. Any two of: “a pounding heart”, “his hands shook”, “fumbled with the switch”. (“Breath ragged” is not accepted on its own, because it could just mean he was out of breath from the stairs.) (2 marks)

Inference (2d). The author never says “Ellis was scared”. The child finds the clues that show it.

5. The light is weak and could go out, so the boat is in danger. (2 marks)

Language choices. Understanding what a simile suggests, not just spotting it, is an upper-primary reading skill.

6. So there would be a light to use if the main lamp failed; Ellis used it when the lamp would not work. (2 marks)

Inference (2d). The child links a detail from earlier in the story to what happens later.

7. 1 mark each for: the lamp would not work while a boat was in danger in the storm; Ellis fetched and lit his mother's emergency lantern and swung it in the window; the boat saw the light and turned safely towards the harbour. (3 marks)

Summarising (2c). A good summary keeps the main events and leaves out the small details. This is the core Year 5 and 6 reading skill.

8. Proud (or relieved/amazed): he acted bravely, used the lantern she kept for emergencies, and copied what she had done in the last storm. (2 marks)

Giving a view with evidence. There is more than one good answer here. What matters is a sensible feeling backed by evidence from the text.